

11 Cliffs and beach

This rugged and colorful seascape may look complex, but by identifying the underlying colors that unify the whole scene, it is easy to start work. The first washes create an interplay between the warm and cool colors, which establishes perspective and creates a sense of movement, vital in painting the sea. As you build up the subsequent layers of color in the seascape, you can strengthen features and refine detail. Finally, using a razor blade to remove some of the paint from the sea produces broken marks that capture the effect of sunlight sparkling on the water.

EQUIPMENT

- Cold-pressed paper
- Brushes: No. 5, No. 14, ½ in (12.5 mm) and 1 in (25 mm) flat
- Razor blade
- Burnt sienna, cerulean blue, turquoise deep, Windsor violet, cadmium orange, cadmium yellow, emerald green, French ultramarine, alizarin crimson, sap green, burnt umber

TECHNIQUES

- Scraping back



1 Wet the paper, then paint the cliffs burnt sienna, using the 1 in (25 mm) flat brush. Use cerulean blue for the distant sky, blending it into the yellow to create a soft green for the distant hills and the areas of shadow on the cliffs.



2 Paint the sea with a wash of cerulean blue, then drybrush turquoise deep (an Old Windsor color) over the top with the 1 in (25 mm) flat brush, to strengthen the color. Carry the turquoise over onto the beach.

BUILDING THE IMAGE

